Attitudes Toward Debt and Household Borrowing Behavior

U.S. Survey of Consumer Finances, 2010-2022

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Abstract

This paper examines whether changes in U.S. household debt attitudes are quantitatively informative about actual borrowing behavior. I assemble repeated cross-sections from the Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF) for 2010, 2016, and 2022, merge supplementary opinion modules, and estimate survey-weighted descriptive and regression models. Four results stand out. First, attitudes shift toward debt acceptance: the weighted share reporting debt as a "good idea" rises from 21.9% in 2010 to 26.5% in 2022, while the "bad idea" share falls from 36.1% to 29.5%. Second, this shift remains after controlling for income, age, education, wealth, and debt burden. Third, attitudes are behaviorally informative: conditional on controls, moving from the least favorable to the most favorable attitude is associated with about $24,232 higher debt in 2022 dollars. Fourth, heterogeneity is stronger by age than by formal schooling: younger households shift more quickly toward debt-friendly views, while trend differentials by college status are statistically weak. Identification-oriented robustness designs (dynamic DDD, IV, RD-style local checks, and event-study interactions) reinforce the same qualitative pattern while clarifying that the strongest and most robust heterogeneity runs along age rather than schooling margins. Purpose-specific evidence from `X402`, `X403`, and `X405` shows a stable hierarchy in which car debt is broadly accepted, living-expense debt is moderately accepted and rising, and vacation debt remains least accepted. The analysis is explicitly associational, but it shows that debt-attitude variables contain independent signal for household-finance models.

Introduction

Household debt plays a dual role in finance and macroeconomics. At the micro level, borrowing allows intertemporal smoothing and durable-goods acquisition. At the macro level, leverage amplifies exposure to income shocks and asset-price revaluations. Standard frameworks explain debt with resources, risk, collateral, and borrowing constraints; however, observed debt behavior also depends on how households *evaluate* borrowing as a choice. This paper focuses on that attitudinal channel using direct survey responses in the U.S. Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF).

The core research question is straightforward: did debt attitudes become more favorable between 2010 and 2022, and does that attitudinal variation map into actual debt levels after conditioning on household characteristics?

The period is useful for identification of broad patterns even without causal design. It includes the post-global-financial-crisis environment, prolonged low rates, large housing and equity repricing episodes, and substantial shifts in household balance-sheet composition. If social norms or preferences regarding debt changed in this period, we should observe movement in debt-attitude distributions and corresponding differences in borrowing outcomes.

The paper makes five linked contributions in a single empirical framework. It builds a transparent multi-wave SCF dataset with harmonized inflation-adjusted variables, documents weighted trend movement in general debt attitudes, estimates conditional trend models that separate year effects from observable composition, quantifies the dollar magnitude linking attitudes to debt holdings, and evaluates heterogeneity by age, education, and borrowing purpose. Throughout, the emphasis is on measurement discipline, precise interpretation, and direct translation from coefficients to economically meaningful magnitudes.

Economic Background and Literature

SCF as a Measurement Framework

The SCF is the canonical U.S. household-finance survey for assets, liabilities, and income. Its design combines a standard area-probability sample with a list-based oversample of wealthy families, which improves measurement of upper-tail wealth and debt. This design requires survey weighting for population inference. For debt-attitude analysis, the SCF provides a rare combination of subjective responses and objective balance-sheet outcomes in the same household-level record.

Household Debt in Finance and Macro-Finance

In lifecycle and buffer-stock settings, households borrow when current resources are low relative to expected future resources (Modigliani and Brumberg, 1954). Liquidity constraints and contract frictions limit this smoothing (Zeldes, 1989; Gross and Souleles, 2002). In household-finance data, debt portfolios also reflect financial sophistication, expectations, and risk perceptions (Campbell, 2006). At the macro level, household leverage interacts with consumption dynamics and downturn severity (Mian and Sufi, 2010; Mian, Rao, and Sufi, 2013).

A reduced-form implication is that debt outcomes should depend on both fundamentals and subjective attitude variables. This paper tests that implication directly.

Behavioral Channel and Norm Formation

Behavioral household-finance work emphasizes that literacy, beliefs, and framing alter financial choices (Lusardi and Mitchell, 2014). Debt-attitude questions in SCF can be interpreted as a noisy proxy for aversion to borrowing or perceived social acceptability of debt use. If attitudes shift over time, then even after controlling for income and wealth, debt behavior may move through this preference/norm channel.

Conceptual Framework and Choice-Based Interpretation

I model household borrowing as a choice under resources, borrowing cost, and debt aversion. Household i in year t chooses debt D_{it} to maximize utility

$$\max_{D_{it}} \ u(C_{it}) - \phi(A_{it})\, g(D_{it}),$$

with budget identity

$$C_{it} = Y_{it} + D_{it} - R_t D_{it} + \Omega_{it}.$$

Here Y_{it} is disposable income, Ω_{it} captures assets and net worth, R_t is the effective borrowing price, and A_{it} is latent debt aversion. The SCF variable `X401` is interpreted as an observed ordinal proxy for A_{it}, with lower values indicating lower aversion to debt. The first-order condition

$$u'(C_{it})(1 - R_t) = \phi(A_{it}) g'(D_{it})$$

implies that, conditional on resources and credit cost, lower debt aversion shifts optimal debt upward.

To represent the survey attitude response more explicitly, let latent attitude be

$$\begin{aligned} A^*_{it} = \pi_0 + \pi_1 \log(Income_{it}) + \pi_2 Age_{it} + \pi_3 Educ_{it} \\ + \pi_4 \log(NetWorth_{it}) + \pi_5 Debt2Inc_{it} + \pi_6 Year_t + \eta_{it}, \end{aligned}$$

and let the observed response `X401` satisfy ordered thresholds

$$X401_{it} = j \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \kappa_{j-1} < A^*_{it} \le \kappa_j, \qquad j \in \{1, \dots, 5\}.$$

This is an ordered-choice representation of attitude reporting. In the empirical implementation, I estimate weighted linear models on the observed `X401` scale for transparency and comparability, while retaining the ordered-latent interpretation as the conceptual benchmark.

A second equation links attitudes to realized debt:

$$D_{it} = \alpha + \theta X401_{it} + \delta_{year} + \Gamma' Z_{it} + u_{it}.$$

If `X401` is a valid monotone proxy for debt aversion, the model predicts $\theta < 0$ because lower `X401` means stronger debt acceptance. The same framework also predicts systematic variation by borrowing purpose: necessity-related debt should be more acceptable than discretionary debt if households attach different normative costs across uses.

This setup motivates three empirical questions: whether population attitudes shifted over 2010-2022, whether those shifts remain after conditioning on observables, and whether stated attitudes align with realized debt outcomes. Because attitudes and debt may be jointly determined, all estimates are interpreted as conditional associations rather than causal treatment effects.

Data

Data Sources and Sample Construction

The analysis uses three public waves of the U.S. Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF): 2010, 2016, and 2022.[1] For each wave, I combine the SCF Summary Extract (balance sheet, income, demographics, and debt outcomes) with the supplementary attitudes module (opinion responses on borrowing). The SCF design combines a broad area-probability sample with a list sample that oversamples wealthy households, which is essential for measuring the upper tail of U.S. household balance sheets.[2] The merge keys follow SCF codebook identifiers: survey wave (`YEAR`), household identifier (`YY1`), and implicate index (`Y1`).[3] Because each interviewed household is released with five implicates under SCF multiple-imputation procedures, the final pooled sample contains 86,625 implicate-level observations (17,325 household interviews times 5) and 399 variables.

Data Processing

The processing pipeline harmonizes variable types and coding across waves, applies consistency checks, and reduces outlier sensitivity through 1st/99th percentile winsorization for major monetary variables. It then constructs transformed covariates used in estimation, including log income, transformed net worth, debt-to-income, and demographic indicators for age and schooling groups.

[1]Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, Survey of Consumer Finances public data portal, 2010 wave documentation, and 2016 wave documentation.

[2]Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, Survey of Consumer Finances public data portal, 2010 wave documentation, and 2016 wave documentation.

[3]SCF codebooks (University of Michigan Survey Research Center distribution): 2010, 2016, and 2022.

The final validation step enforces admissible response ranges for the debt-attitude items and confirms complete key linkage across modules.

Variables for Estimation

The key attitudinal variable is `X401`, which asks whether borrowing to buy needed goods when income is cut is a good or bad idea. The purpose-specific items are `X402` (vacation borrowing), `X403` (borrowing for living expenses when income is cut), and `X405` (borrowing to buy a car).[4] The primary behavioral outcome is log real household debt (`LOG_DEBT`), and the baseline control set includes age, education, transformed income and wealth measures, and debt-to-income ratios.

Weights and Inference

Because the SCF design oversamples wealthy households, unweighted moments are not population-representative. All descriptive statistics, plots, and regressions therefore use survey weights based on `WGT` (or year-normalized equivalents used in construction checks). Inference is reported with HC3 robust standard errors under weighted least squares. Design-consistent replicate-weight inference is a natural extension and is discussed in the limitations section.

Empirical Design

Baseline Attitude Trend Model

$$x_{it}^{(401)} = \alpha + \delta_{2016} D_{2016,t} + \delta_{2022} D_{2022,t} + \gamma' \mathbf{Z}_{it} + \varepsilon_{it}.$$

Here $x_{it}^{(401)}$ is the observed response on `X401`, $D_{2016,t}$ and $D_{2022,t}$ are survey-wave indicators (with 2010 omitted), and $\mathbf{Z}_{it}$ collects `LOG_INCOME_ADJ`, `AGE`, `EDUC`, `LOG_NETWORTH_ADJ`, and `DEBT2INC`. Since `X401` is coded so that lower values indicate more favorable debt attitudes, negative estimates of δ_{2016} and δ_{2022} imply greater debt acceptance relative to 2010 after conditioning on observables. The model is estimated by weighted least squares with SCF survey weights and HC3 robust standard errors. Because `X401` is ordinal, coefficients are interpreted as average shifts on the observed 1-5 scale rather than structural cardinal effects.

Attitude-Behavior Alignment Model

$$\log(1 + Debt_{it}) = \alpha + \theta x_{it}^{(401)} + \eta_{2016} D_{2016,t} + \eta_{2022} D_{2022,t} + \beta' \mathbf{W}_{it} + u_{it}.$$

In this equation, the dependent variable is `LOG_DEBT`, and $\mathbf{W}_{it}$ contains age, education, log income, and log net worth. The parameter of interest is θ. Under the choice-based framework above, $\theta < 0$

[4] In the SCF codebooks, `X401`, `X402`, `X403`, and `X405` are debt-opinion items with purpose-specific question wording on borrowing for needed purchases, vacations, living expenses, and car purchases.

is expected, because lower `X401` corresponds to lower debt aversion and therefore higher desired borrowing.

Heterogeneity Models

For heterogeneity, I estimate year-interaction models of the form

$$X401_{it} = \alpha + \sum_{k\in\{2016,2022\}} \delta_k D_{k,t} + \lambda_1 G_i + \sum_{k\in\{2016,2022\}} \lambda_k (D_{k,t} \times G_i) + \Gamma' Z_{it} + \nu_{it},$$

where G includes `YOUNG` (age < 40) and `COLLEGE`. The interaction coefficients λ_k measure whether post-2010 attitude shifts differ systematically across groups.

Purpose-Specific Comparisons

For each of `X402`, `X403`, and `X405`, I define an acceptance indicator $\mathbf{1}[X \leq 2]$ and report weighted acceptance rates by year. This harmonized coding allows direct comparison between discretionary and necessity-linked borrowing contexts.

Results I: Descriptive Patterns

Aggregate Shift in General Debt Attitudes

Table 1 reports weighted shares by attitude category.

Year	Good (`X401<=2`)	Mixed (`X401=3`)	Bad (`X401>=4`)
2010	21.9%	42.0%	36.1%
2016	25.9%	42.4%	31.7%
2022	26.5%	44.0%	29.5%

The favorable share increases by 4.6 percentage points and the unfavorable share declines by 6.6 percentage points over the sample window. Weighted mean `X401` falls from 3.284 (2010) to 3.060 (2022), consistent with a broad shift toward acceptance.

Acceptance Depends on Debt Purpose

Purpose-specific attitudes are not uniform.

Purpose	2010	2016	2022
Vacation (`X402`)	13.9%	10.3%	13.0%

Purpose	2010	2016	2022
Living expenses (X403)	50.6%	56.6%	63.1%
Car purchase (X405)	76.9%	76.3%	75.7%

Car borrowing remains broadly accepted, living-expense borrowing rises strongly, and vacation borrowing stays low. This ranking indicates households distinguish necessity-linked from discretionary debt.

Debt Levels Across Attitude Groups

Weighted mean debt is monotonically lower for less debt-friendly attitudes when pooling years. The weighted mean is $163,539 for X401=1, $159,956 for X401=3, and $122,873 for X401=5. The same ordering appears within survey year; in 2022, mean debt is $138,123 for the favorable group and $96,731 for the unfavorable group.

The complementary pooled-category plot below uses the full five-point X401 scale and confirms the same monotone relationship: households reporting more debt-friendly views hold higher average real debt levels.

Distributional Pattern by Income Quintile

Debt-favorable attitudes rise in four of five income quintiles from 2010 to 2022. The good-attitude share moves from 20.7% to 25.1% in Q1, 19.7% to 26.6% in Q2, 21.7% to 27.3% in Q3, and 24.8% to 28.1% in Q4, while Q5 declines from 24.8% to 22.8%. This pattern suggests broad middle-distribution movement toward debt acceptance with a distinct top-quintile pattern.

Results II: Multivariate Evidence

Baseline Attitude Model

Table 3 reports the two benchmark regressions in a harmonized format.

Explanatory Variable	Model 1: Debt Attitude Score (X401)	Model 2: Debt Holdings (LOG_DEBT)
Constant	3.7187*** (0.1393)	-2.1439*** (0.7121)
Year 2016 (vs. 2010)	-0.1718*** (0.0301)	0.0643 (0.0895)
Year 2022 (vs. 2010)	-0.2284*** (0.0362)	0.2164** (0.1065)
Debt-attitude score (X401)		-0.2003*** (0.0264)
Log real income	-0.0523*** (0.0128)	1.0520*** (0.0685)

Explanatory Variable	Model 1: Debt Attitude Score (X401)	Model 2: Debt Holdings (LOG_DEBT)
Age of household head	0.0058*** (0.0009)	-0.0550*** (0.0027)
Education (years)	-0.0090* (0.0053)	0.2751*** (0.0182)
Log real net worth	-0.0059*** (0.0020)	-0.0633*** (0.0046)
Debt-to-income ratio	0.0011 (0.0023)	
Observations	86,625	86,625
R^2	0.0115	0.1698

In Model 1, lower `X401` means more debt-friendly attitudes, so negative coefficients imply stronger debt acceptance.

Both post-2010 year indicators are negative and precise, implying that debt attitudes become more favorable even after controls. Income and net worth enter with signs consistent with greater debt acceptance among higher-resource households. Age is positive, implying relatively less favorable debt attitudes among older households, all else equal.

Behavior Consistency Model

The debt-behavior specification in Table 3 confirms strong attitude-behavior alignment.

The `X401` coefficient is estimated in log debt units. A one-point increase in `X401` (less debt-friendly attitude) is associated with about 18.2% lower debt holdings. Equivalently, moving from `X401=5` to `X401=1` implies approximately 122.9% higher predicted debt, conditional on controls.

Heterogeneity Results

Table 4 reports the interaction model where age and college heterogeneity are estimated jointly.

Coefficient (DV: X401)	Estimate (s.e.)
Year 2016 (vs. 2010)	-0.1599*** (0.0423)
Year 2022 (vs. 2010)	-0.1711*** (0.0517)
Young household (AGE < 40)	0.0246 (0.0572)
2016 x Young	-0.1554** (0.0667)
2022 x Young	-0.2011** (0.0819)
College household	-0.0921 (0.0586)
2016 x College	0.1034 (0.0631)
2022 x College	0.0157 (0.0730)
Observations	86,625
R^2	0.0128

Coefficient (DV: `X401`)	Estimate (s.e.)

The age interaction is economically meaningful and statistically strong, whereas the education interaction is weak. Descriptive weighted good-share trends are consistent with this pattern: young households rise from 22.8% (2010) to 31.4% (2022), while older households rise from 21.5% to 24.6%.

Standard errors are in parentheses. All models use SCF survey weights with household-cluster robust standard errors. Significance: *** p<0.01, ** p<0.05, * p<0.10.

Robustness and Additional Designs

Fixed-Effects-Style Composition Controls

I estimate an extended attitude equation with year indicators and rich categorical controls for income quintile, race category, age group, and education group. The post-2010 year effects remain negative and precise: -0.1718 (s.e. 0.0302) for 2016 and -0.2370 (s.e. 0.0362) for 2022 relative to 2010. This indicates that the aggregate move toward debt-favorable responses is not driven by simple compositional shifts in observables.

Difference-in-Differences and Triple Differences

To sharpen heterogeneity interpretation, I estimate a post-2022 DID using young households as the treated group, and then a DDD that adds college status.

Design	Target Interaction	Coef. (s.e.)	p-value
DID	Young x Post-2022	-0.1285 (0.0757)	0.090
DDD	Young x College x Post-2022	-0.2274 (0.1525)	0.136

The DID point estimate suggests a stronger debt-favorability shift among younger households in 2022, while the triple interaction is less precisely estimated.

In a more flexible dynamic DDD with full `YEAR × YOUNG × COLLEGE` interactions, the triple interaction is -0.0436 (s.e. 0.1425) for 2016 and -0.2574 (s.e. 0.1681) for 2022, both relative to 2010. The 2022 point estimate is economically meaningful and directionally consistent with stronger youth-specific debt-favorability, although precision remains limited.

Event-Study Dynamics

With 2010 as the reference period, I estimate dynamic interactions between survey year and the young-household indicator. For debt attitudes (`X401`), the interaction coefficients are -0.1587 (s.e.

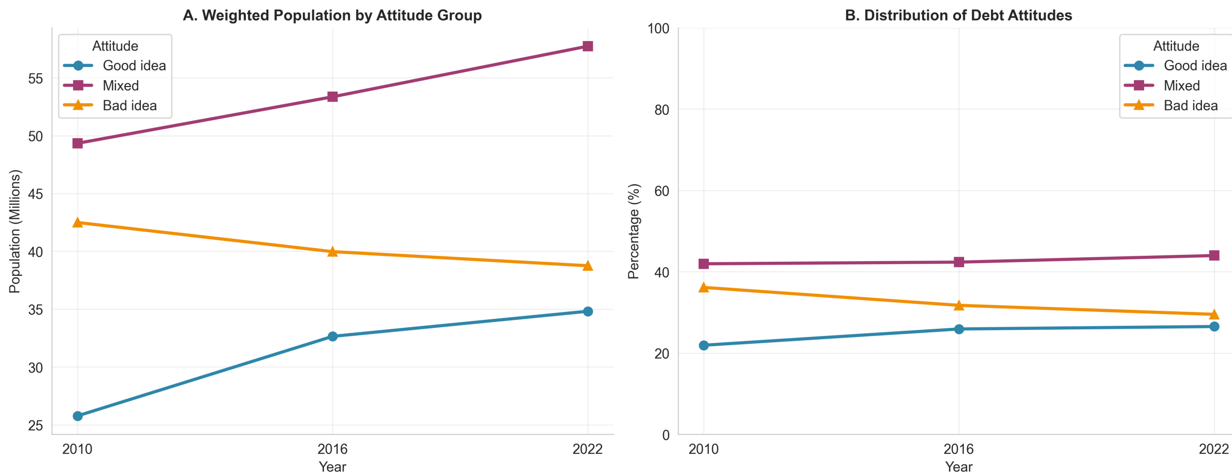

Figure 1: Weighted trend in debt attitudes (`X401`), SCF 2010/2016/2022.

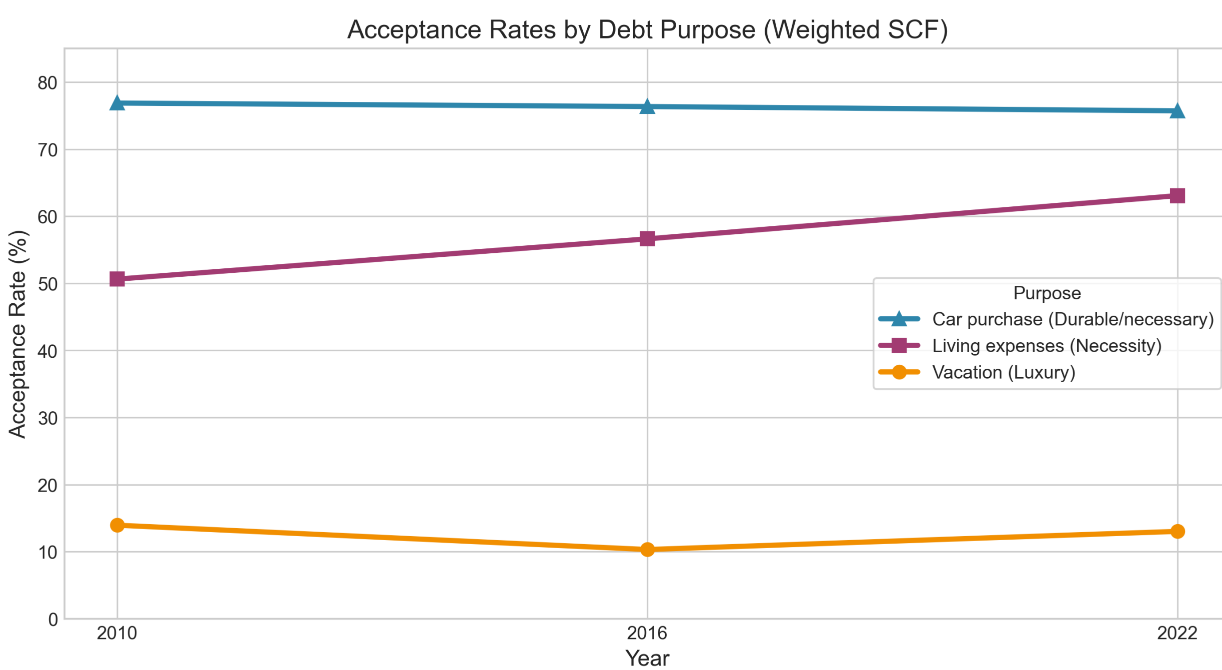

Figure 2: Acceptance rates by debt purpose (`X402`, `X403`, `X405`).

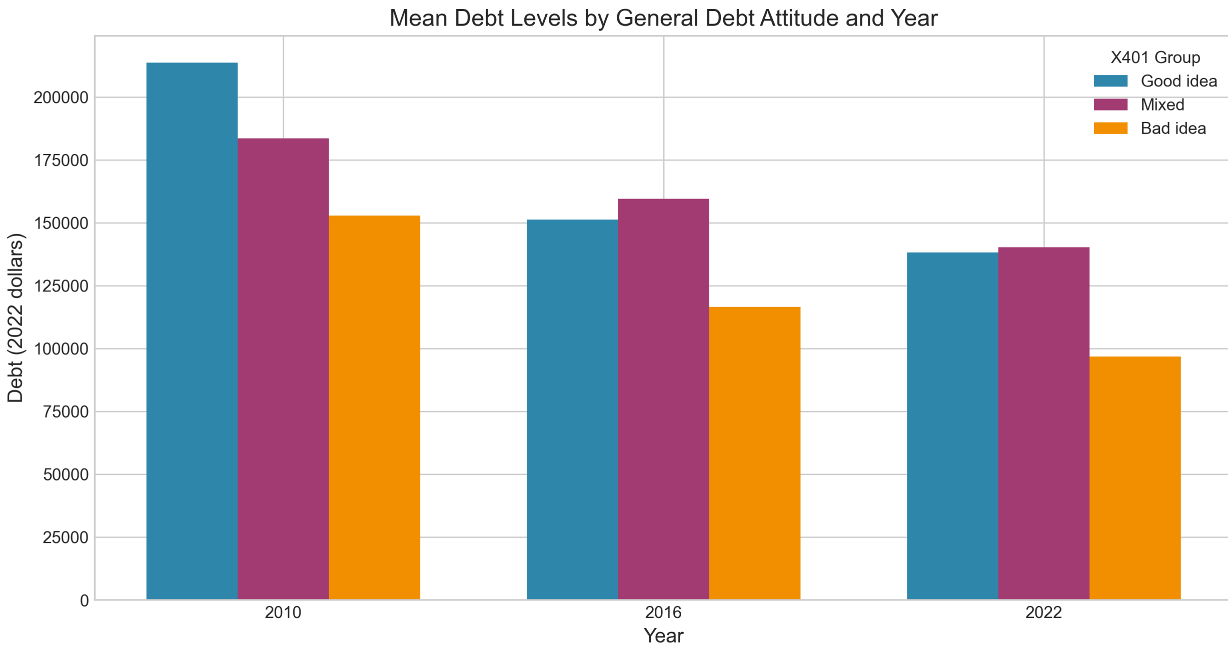

Figure 3: Mean debt levels by attitude group and year.

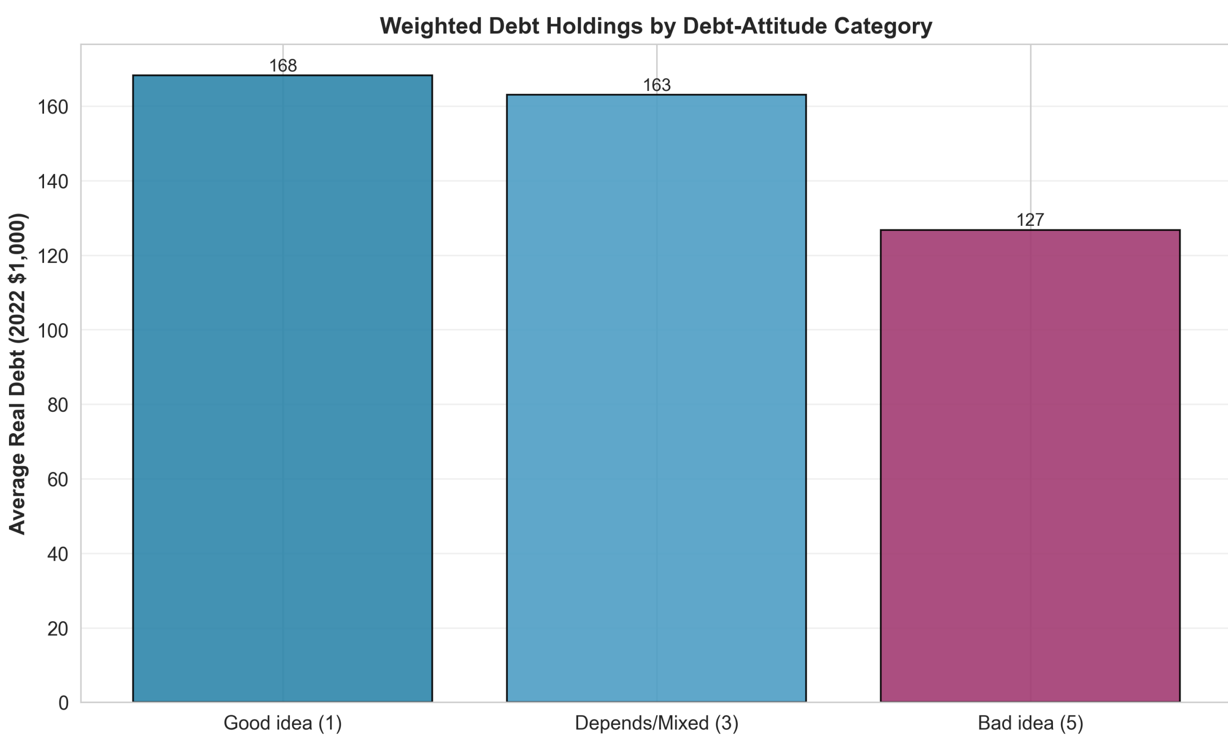

Figure 4: Weighted average real debt by full `X401` attitude categories.

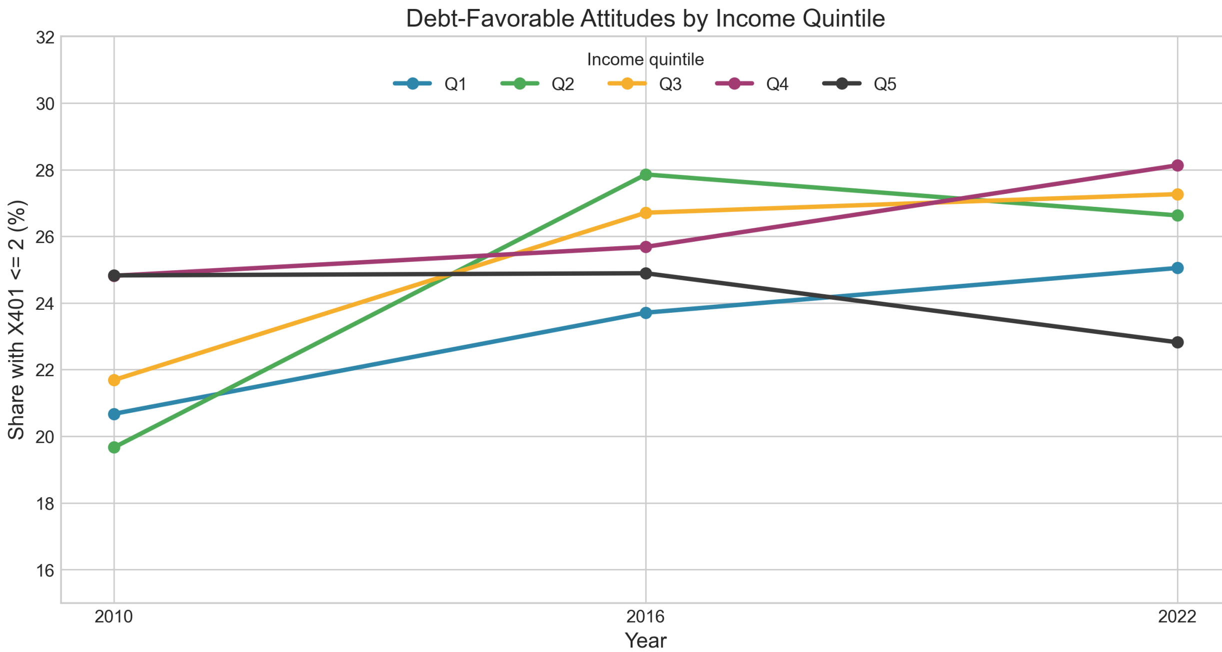

Figure 5: Debt-favorable share by income quintile.

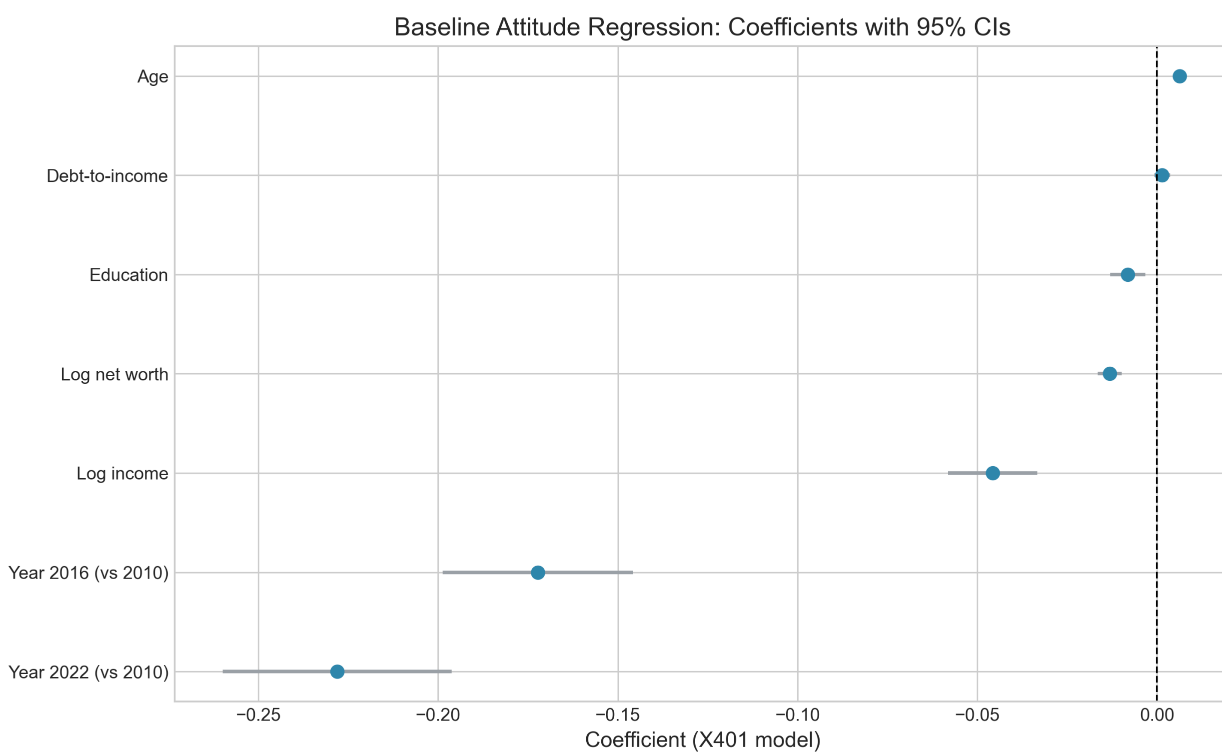

Figure 6: Baseline `X401` regression coefficients with 95% confidence intervals.

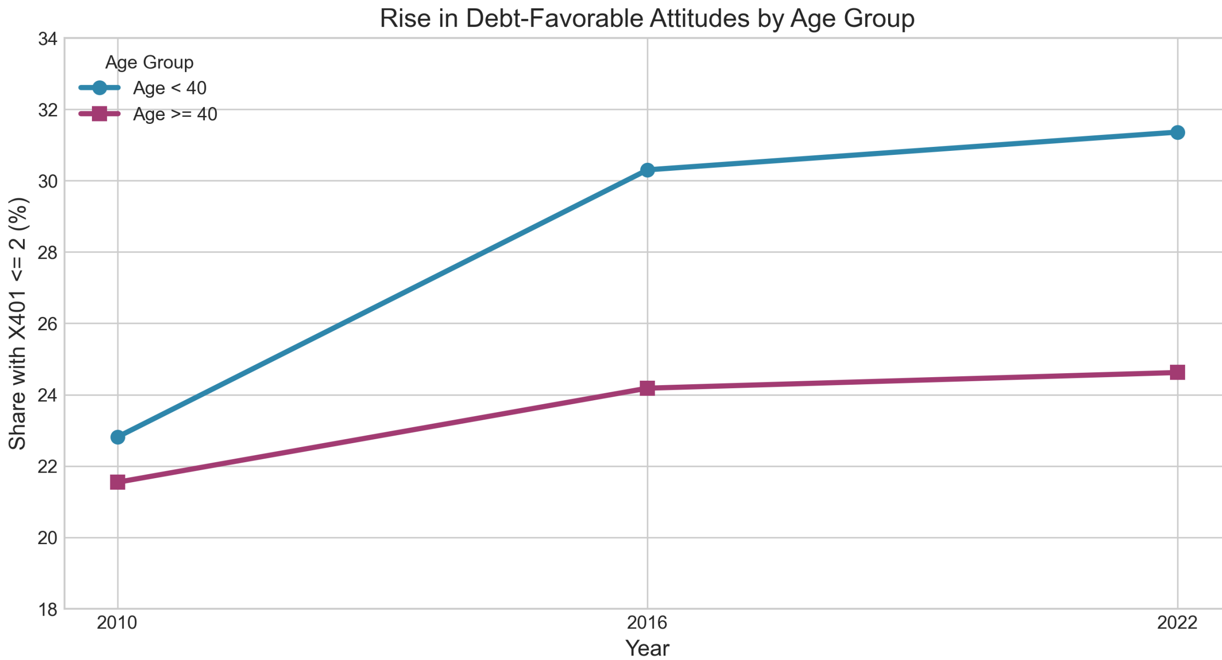

Figure 7: Debt-favorable attitude trend by age group.

0.0666) in 2016 and -0.2055 (s.e. 0.0818) in 2022, consistent with progressively stronger debt-favorability among younger households. For debt holdings (`LOG_DEBT`), the 2016 interaction is close to zero (-0.0496, s.e. 0.1861), while the 2022 interaction is positive and marginally significant (0.4372, s.e. 0.2184), indicating a later relative increase in debt among younger households.

Instrumental-Variables Evidence (2SLS)

I estimate a 2SLS debt equation treating `X401` as endogenous and instrumenting it with purpose-specific attitude indicators based on `X402`, `X403`, and `X405`. This design asks whether variation in general debt attitudes that is aligned with purpose-level borrowing preferences also predicts debt outcomes.

The first-stage is strong (F-statistic = 1156.4). The IV coefficient on `X401` in the `LOG_DEBT` equation is -1.4989 (s.e. 0.1063, $p<0.001$), preserving the negative sign expected under the debt-aversion interpretation. Because the instruments are attitude-space variables rather than external policy shocks, exclusion restrictions are demanding; accordingly, this evidence is interpreted as supportive robustness rather than point-identifying causal treatment effects.

RD-Style Local Design around Age 40

I also estimate local linear RD-style models around the age-40 boundary used to classify young households in the heterogeneity analysis. Within a symmetric 10-year bandwidth, the estimated cutoff discontinuities are small and statistically weak: 0.0367 (s.e. 0.0856) for `X401` and -0.1144

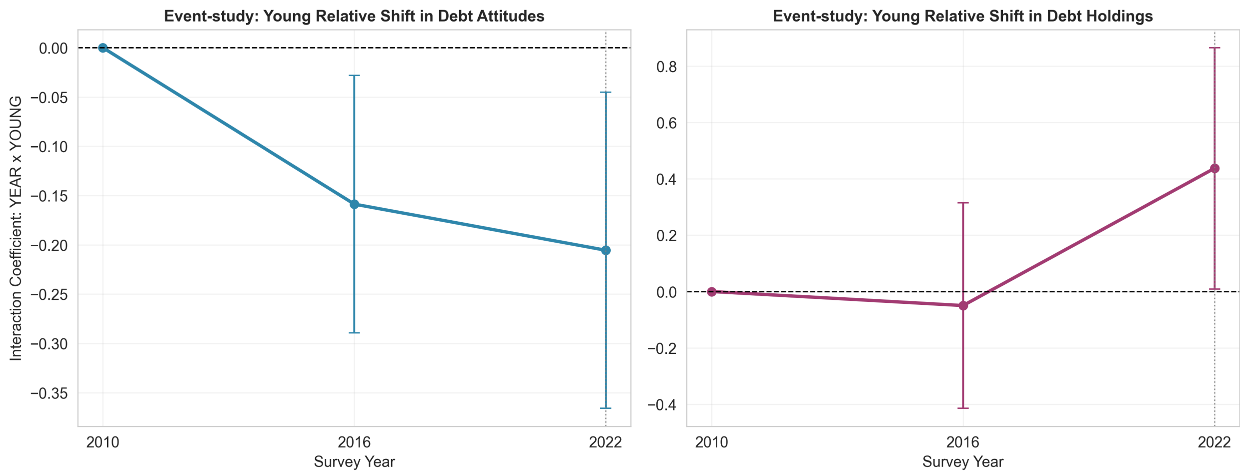

Figure 8: Event-study interactions for attitudes and debt holdings (young relative to older households, base year 2010).

(s.e. 0.2036) for `LOG_DEBT`. This indicates no sharp mechanical level jump exactly at the threshold, reinforcing the interpretation that the heterogeneity results reflect broader age-gradient dynamics rather than a narrow cutoff artifact.

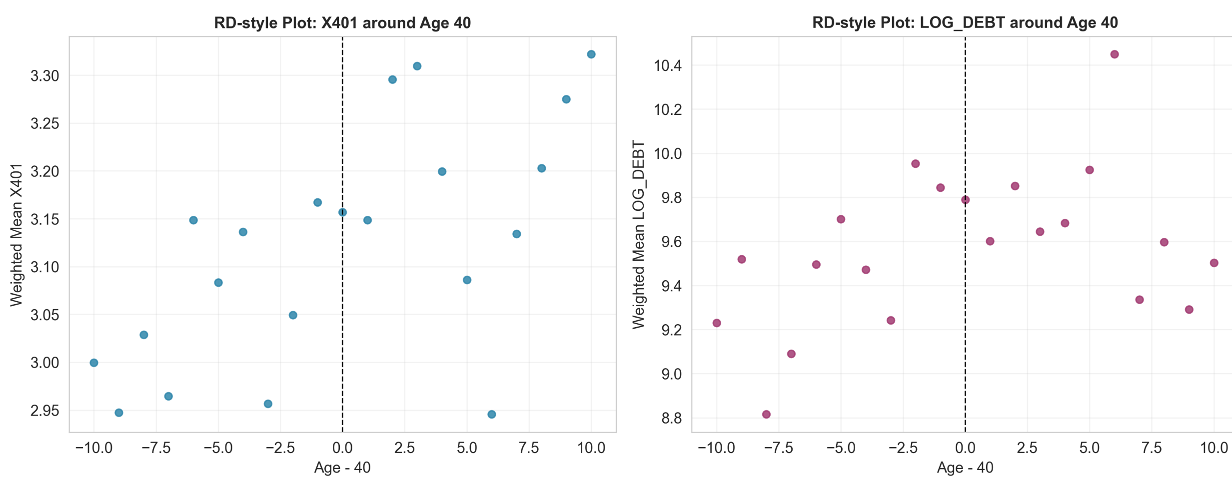

Figure 9: RD-style local patterns around the age-40 threshold for attitudes and debt outcomes.

Synthetic-Control-Style Aggregate Check

As an additional reduced-form check, I construct a synthetic comparison path for the under-35 group's mean `X401` using nonnegative donor weights on older age groups and matching pre-2022 observations. The estimated 2022 treated-minus-synthetic gap is -0.1718, and the pre-period RMSPE is 0.1183. This provides complementary evidence that the under-35 group's shift is larger than what is predicted by donor-group dynamics alone.

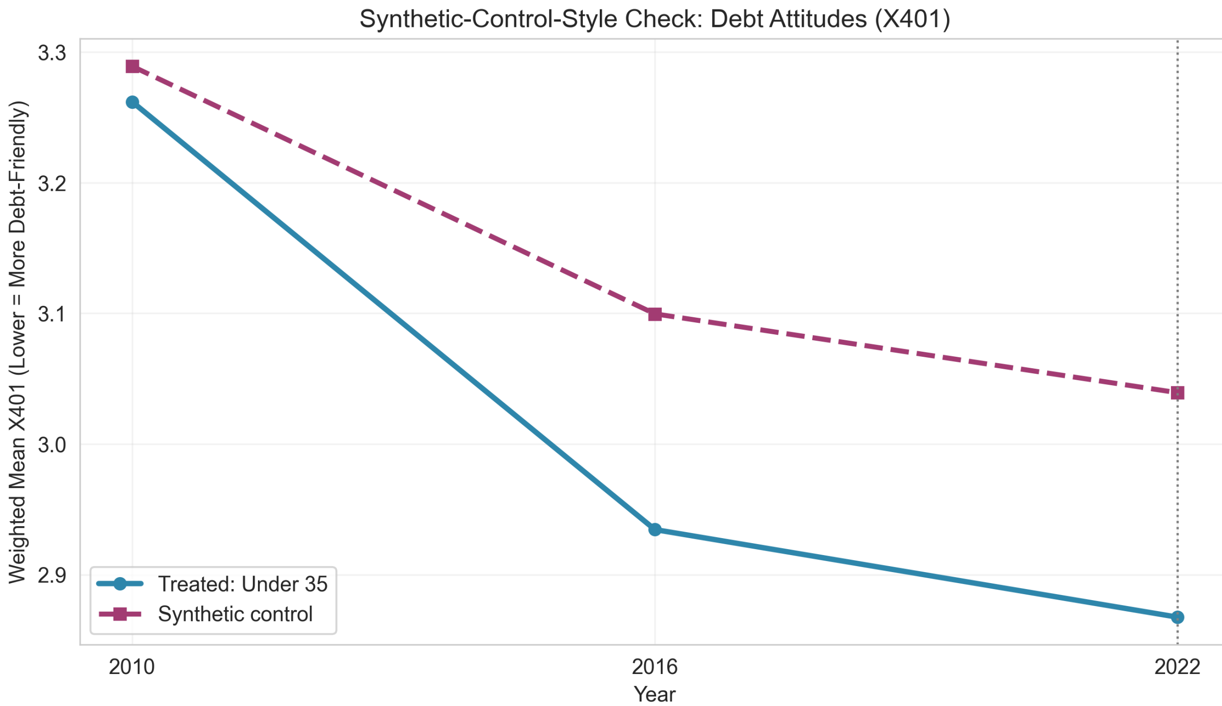

Figure 10: Synthetic-control-style path for under-35 debt attitudes (`X401`).

Identification Limits

These designs improve structure and transparency, but they do not fully resolve identification. The data are repeated cross-sections (not a household panel), attitude and debt outcomes may still be jointly determined, the time dimension has only three waves, and the IV strategy uses internal-attitude instruments rather than external shocks. The estimates should therefore be interpreted as disciplined reduced-form evidence rather than causal treatment effects.

Economic Interpretation for Finance

The results indicate that debt attitudes carry independent signal beyond standard resource controls. Income and net worth are important covariates, but year effects in the attitude equation and the `X401` coefficient in the debt equation remain economically and statistically meaningful after conditioning on observables. Purpose-specific responses also suggest that attitude measures capture structured economic judgments rather than survey noise: households report high acceptance for car debt, intermediate and rising acceptance for living-expense debt, and persistently low acceptance for vacation debt. Heterogeneity estimates further show that trend shifts are concentrated by age rather than by college status in this sample window, implying that cohort composition may affect aggregate leverage demand even when educational composition is relatively stable. For applied household-finance analysis, these patterns support including attitude variables in reduced-form models of debt demand, risk segmentation, and scenario design.

Conclusion

Using SCF 2010/2016/2022 data, this paper documents a broad increase in U.S. debt acceptance and shows that debt attitudes are strongly associated with realized debt levels. The relationship is economically large, robust to core observables, and heterogeneous by age group. Purpose-specific attitudes indicate that households separate necessity and discretionary borrowing in a stable way over time.

The main contribution is empirical clarity: debt attitudes are not peripheral survey artifacts. They are informative state variables for household-finance analysis. The next step for doctoral-level research is to move from this reduced-form evidence to designs with stronger identification of mechanisms, especially by integrating credit-supply shocks and design-consistent SCF variance methods.

Appendix: Full Regression Tables

This appendix reports the regression outputs used in the paper from the main, heterogeneity, and additional robustness estimations.

Additional Robustness Summary

Model	Coefficient of Interest	Estimate (s.e.)	p-value
FE-style `X401`	Year 2016 vs 2010	-0.1718 (0.0302)	<0.001
FE-style `X401`	Year 2022 vs 2010	-0.2370 (0.0362)	<0.001
DID `X401`	Young x Post-2022	-0.1285 (0.0757)	0.090
DDD `X401`	Young x College x Post-2022	-0.2274 (0.1525)	0.136
Dynamic DDD `X401`	Young x College x 2016	-0.0436 (0.1425)	0.760
Dynamic DDD `X401`	Young x College x 2022	-0.2574 (0.1681)	0.126
IV-2SLS `LOG_DEBT`	Effect of `X401`	-1.4989 (0.1063)	<0.001
IV First Stage	F-statistic	1156.4	
RD-style (`|age-40|<=10`)	Discontinuity in `X401`	0.0367 (0.0856)	0.668
RD-style (`|age-40|<=10`)	Discontinuity in `LOG_DEBT`	-0.1144 (0.2036)	0.574
Event-study `X401`	Young x 2016	-0.1587 (0.0666)	0.017
Event-study `X401`	Young x 2022	-0.2055 (0.0818)	0.012
Event-study `LOG_DEBT`	Young x 2016	-0.0496 (0.1861)	0.790
Event-study `LOG_DEBT`	Young x 2022	0.4372 (0.2184)	0.045

Main Regression Coefficients (Readable Labels)

Explanatory Variable	Model 1: Debt Attitude (`X401`)	Model 2: Debt Holdings (`LOG_DEBT`)
Constant	3.7187*** (0.1393)	-2.1439*** (0.7121)
Year 2016 (vs. 2010)	-0.1718*** (0.0301)	0.0643 (0.0895)
Year 2022 (vs. 2010)	-0.2284*** (0.0362)	0.2164** (0.1065)

Explanatory Variable	Model 1: Debt Attitude (X401)	Model 2: Debt Holdings (LOG_DEBT)
Debt-attitude score (X401)		-0.2003*** (0.0264)
Log real income	-0.0523*** (0.0128)	1.0520*** (0.0685)
Age of household head	0.0058*** (0.0009)	-0.0550*** (0.0027)
Education (years)	-0.0090* (0.0053)	0.2751*** (0.0182)
Log real net worth	-0.0059*** (0.0020)	-0.0633*** (0.0046)
Debt-to-income ratio	0.0011 (0.0023)	
Observations	86,625	86,625
R^2	0.0115	0.1698

Interaction Model Coefficients (Joint Age and College Heterogeneity)

Coefficient (DV: X401)	Estimate (s.e.)
Year 2016 (vs. 2010)	-0.1599*** (0.0423)
Year 2022 (vs. 2010)	-0.1711*** (0.0517)
Young household (AGE < 40)	0.0246 (0.0572)
2016 x Young	-0.1554** (0.0667)
2022 x Young	-0.2011** (0.0819)
College household	-0.0921 (0.0586)
2016 x College	0.1034 (0.0631)
2022 x College	0.0157 (0.0730)
Log real income	-0.0540*** (0.0130)
Age of household head	0.0042*** (0.0013)
Education (years)	-0.0022 (0.0081)
Log real net worth	-0.0059*** (0.0020)
Debt-to-income ratio	0.0010 (0.0024)
Observations	86,625
R^2	0.0128

All appendix regressions use SCF survey weights with household-cluster robust standard errors. Standard errors are shown in parentheses.

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